

Word family: **door / doors / doorway / doorstep**

Base word: door

Plural: doors

Useful related forms / extensions: doorway, doorstep

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “To be honest, speaking to him sometimes feels less like small talk and more like opening a **door** to a different way of thinking.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **door** is figurative.

It means an **opportunity, access point, or way of entering a new area of thought, experience, knowledge, or possibility**.

The speaker means that talking to Mr. Wong can introduce him to a completely different way of seeing and understanding things.

繁體中文： ** **通往新的思想、經驗、知識或可能性的入口或機會，使人能進入原本未接觸的領域

**中文翻譯： **

> “...more like opening a **door** to a different way of thinking.”

「.....反而更像是**打開一道通往另一種思考方式的門 / 開啟接觸另一種思考方式的機會**。」

Here:

open a door to something = 開啟接觸、進入或發展某種新機會、新領域或新可能性的途徑

1. **door = movable barrier at an entrance (門) — 門 ; 門扇**

This is the basic physical meaning.

Meaning: A movable structure used to open or close an entrance to a room, building, vehicle, cupboard, etc.

Practice 1

> “She opened the **door** and walked into the room.”

「她打開**門**，走進房間。」

Practice 2

> “Please close the **door** quietly.”

「請輕輕把**門**關上。」

door = 安裝在入口位置、可以開關，用來讓人或物進出或把空間封閉起來的活動結構

Common:

- * front door
- * bedroom door
- * car door
- * cupboard door
- * glass door

These remain one underlying physical-object sense.

2. **door** = entrance/access point (出入口) — 門口；入口

Sometimes **door** refers less to the physical panel and more to the **entrance itself**.

Practice 3

> “Someone was waiting at the **door**.”

「有人正在**門口**等候。」

Practice 4

> “There was a long queue outside the **door**.”

「**入口 / 門外**排着一條長隊。」

door = 讓人進出某個房間、建築物或場所的入口位置

For database counting, I would normally **merge this with Meaning 1**, because the physical door and entrance location are very closely connected.

3. **door = access/opportunity to something (機會 / 途徑) — 通道 ; 機會 ; 入口**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A way of gaining access to a new opportunity, field, experience, relationship, career, idea, or possibility.

Practice 5 — Original

> “Speaking to him feels like opening a **door** to a different way of thinking.”

「和他聊天感覺像是**打開一道通往另一種思考方式的門**。」

Practice 6

> “Learning another language can open the **door** to new cultures.”

「學習另一種語言可以**開啟接觸不同文化的機會**。」

Practice 7

> “The internship opened a **door** to a career in journalism.”

「這次實習為他**開啟了進入新聞行業的機會 / 途徑**。」

door to something = 讓人能夠接觸、進入或發展某個新領域、機會或可能性的途徑

This is a genuine figurative sense and should be kept separate from the physical door.

4. **open/close the door to + possibility (可能性) — 使成為可能 / 排除可能

A related figurative construction focuses specifically on allowing or preventing future possibilities.

Practice 8

> “The agreement could **open the door to** further cooperation.”

「這項協議可能**為進一步合作開啟可能性**。」

Practice 9

> “The decision may **close the door on** future negotiations.”

「這項決定可能會**斷絕未來談判的可能性**。」

open the door to something = 令某種情況、機會或發展變得可能

close the door on/to something = 阻止或結束某種機會或可能性

For core counting, I would **merge this with Meaning 3** under the broader concept:

> **access/opportunity/possibility**

5. **door = household/home represented by its entrance (住戶 / 家庭) — 一戶 ; 一家**

In expressions involving houses or neighbouring homes, **door** can represent a household or residence.

Practice 10

> “They live three **doors** down from us.”

「他們住在我們家**相隔三戶的位置**。」

Practice 11

> “She went from **door to door** asking for donations.”

「她**逐家逐戶**上門募捐。」

door = 以住宅入口代表一戶家庭或一個住址

This is metonymic: the **door** stands for the whole household/home.

It is common enough to teach separately.

6. **door = means of entering/leaving an organization or career (機構 / 職業) — 進入或離開某領域的途徑**

This appears in expressions such as:

> **get a foot in the door**

Practice 12

> “The temporary job helped her get a **foot in the door**.”

「那份臨時工作幫助她**取得進入這個行業的機會**。」

Practice 13

> “Once you have a foot in the **door**, it becomes easier to build contacts.”

「一旦你**成功踏入這個領域**，建立人脈就會容易得多。」

This is still based on the broader **access/opportunity** sense.

So I would keep it as a useful fixed expression rather than count it separately.

Fixed expression: **behind closed doors** — 閉門進行；不公開

Practice 14

> “The negotiations took place **behind closed doors**.”

「談判是**閉門 / 不公開地**進行的。」

Practice 15

> “The committee discussed the matter **behind closed doors**.”

「委員會**閉門**討論了這件事。」

behind closed doors = 在不讓公眾或外人參與、觀看或知道詳情的情況下

This is a fixed expression, not a new core meaning of **door**.

Fixed expression: **show someone the door** — 請某人離開；趕走

Practice 16

> “After his rude behaviour, the manager **showed him the door**.”

「他行為無禮之後，經理便**請他離開 / 把他趕走**。」

Practice 17

> “If he causes trouble again, they may show him the **door**.”

「如果他再次惹麻煩，他們可能會**把他趕走**。」

show someone the door = 要某人離開某個地方，通常帶有不歡迎或解僱意味

Fixed expression: **at death's door** — 病危；瀕死

Practice 18

> “He was seriously ill and seemed to be **at death's door**.”

「他病得很重，看起來已經**病危 / 瀕臨死亡**。」

Practice 19

> “She joked that the flu had left her **at death's door**.”

「她開玩笑說流感令她病得像是**快要死了一樣**。」

at death's door = 病得非常嚴重，接近死亡；可字面或誇張使用

This is an idiom and should remain outside the core count.

Related form: **doorway**

Doorway means the opening in a wall through which a door is fitted, or the entrance space itself.

Practice 20

> “He stood in the **doorway**.”

「他站在**門口 / 門框位置**。」

Practice 21

> “A bicycle was blocking the **doorway**.”

「一輛單車堵住了**門口**。」

doorway = 安裝門的開口位置，以及供人出入的門口空間

Related form: **doorstep**

Doorstep means the step or area immediately outside an external door.

Practice 22

> “The package was left on the **doorstep**.”

「包裹被放在**門前台階 / 門口**。」

Practice 23

> “Reporters gathered on his **doorstep**.”

「記者聚集在他家**門口**。」

doorstep = 建築物外門前的台階或緊貼入口的位置

It also appears figuratively:

> **on someone's doorstep**

= extremely close to someone's home or immediate area

Important distinction: **door** vs **doorway**

door

= the movable panel/structure

doorway

= the opening/entrance where the door is located

> “Open the door.”

= 打開門。

> “Stand in the doorway.”

= 站在門口。

This is a useful physical distinction.

Important distinction: **door vs gate**

door

usually closes an entrance in a wall, room, building, vehicle, etc.

gate

usually controls entry through a fence, wall, barrier, airport area, etc.

> house door

> garden gate

They can both control access, but the physical structures and contexts differ.

Important distinction: **door vs entrance**

door

can be the physical movable object.

entrance

means the point/place through which someone enters.

A building can have:

> an entrance without a conventional door

So:

door = physical barrier/opening

entrance = access point

Important distinction: **open the door vs open the door to**

Literal

> “She opened the **door**.”

= 她打開了實體的門。

Figurative

> “The course opened the **door to** new opportunities.”

= 課程開啟了新的機會。

This is the key contrast for your original sentence.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **door**
- * **doors**
- * **doorway**
- * **doorstep**

Useful compounds and expressions include:

- * front door
- * back door
- * door-to-door
- * next door
- * open the door to
- * close the door on
- * behind closed doors
- * show someone the door
- * get a foot in the door

Under the Golden Manual, these should be included where useful but not automatically counted as new meanings when they develop from the same underlying semantic concept.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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door — physical barrier/entrance	安裝在入口位置、可以開關，用來讓人或物進出或把空間封閉起來的活動結構	
door — entrance/access point	讓人進出房間、建築物或其他封閉空間的位置；與實體門義高度相關	
door — figurative access/opportunity	讓人能夠接觸、進入或發展某個新領域、機會、想法或可能性的途徑	
door — household/residence	以住宅入口代表一戶家庭、一個住址或一間住宅	
open/close the door to something	令某種機會或發展成為可能，或阻止其繼續發展；屬於「機會 / 途徑」義	
doorway	安裝門的開口位置，以及供人出入的門口空間	
doorstep	建築物外門前的台階或緊貼入口的位置	

For your original sentence

> "...more like opening a ****door**** to a different way of thinking."

The exact meaning is:

****door = 通往某種新的思想、經驗或可能性的入口 / 途徑****

More specifically:

****open a door to a different way of thinking = 讓人開始接觸並進入另一種思考方式****

So:

> ****opening a door to a different way of thinking****

= ****開啟接觸另一種思考方式的途徑 / 打開一道通往另一種思考方式的門****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****door****:

1. ****physical door / entrance****
2. ****figurative access, opportunity, or route into something****
3. ****household/residence represented by its door****

I would treat ****open the door to, close the door on, get a foot in the door, behind closed doors,**** and ****show someone the door**** as important fixed-expression extensions rather than inflate the core count.